

semiconductor sector and pushed for replicating this success for non-semiconductor components.

Government sets royalty rates for mining lithium, niobium, rare earth elements

The Indian government has approved changes to the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) Act, 1957, setting royalty rates for critical minerals like lithium, niobium, and rare earth elements. Effective from August 17, 2023, the latest amendment has removed minerals like lithium and niobium from the atomic minerals category, allowing the private sector to obtain concessions through auctions. The Central government will oversee auctioning mining leases and composite licenses for 24 pivotal and strategic minerals. The royalty rates for these critical minerals have been defined as follows: Lithium at 3% of the London Metal Exchange price, niobium at 3% of the average sale price, and rare earth elements (REE) at 1% of the average sale price of rare earth oxide.

MoHI seeks additional funding for FAME II

The Ministry of Heavy Industries in India has been allocated ₹51.27 billion for the current fiscal year for the FAME II scheme and is seeking additional funding of ₹15-₹17 billion due to robust electric vehicle sales, which may deplete the allocated funds before March 2024. Earlier, the ministry proposed a 165% increase in allocation for electric 2-wheelers. The registration of EVs has been consistently rising, with sales of high-speed e-scooters increasing by 20% year-on-year and 14% month-on-month to 62,355 units. Electric 3-wheelers also showed significant growth, increasing to 56,747 units in August from 33,130 units in the same period a year ago.

Sparsh CCTV to set up manufacturing unit in Saudi Arabia

Sparsh CCTV, an Indian surveillance camera manufacturer, is partner-

ing with Saudi Arabia-based DAST to establish a CCTV manufacturing plant in Saudi Arabia. The plant is set to begin operations in the first quarter of 2024, targeting the Middle East and North African market. The manufacturing unit will be located in Sudair Industrial City, situated 25 kilometres away from Riyadh. The plant will focus on producing cameras and recorders, emphasizing products with resolutions of eight megapixels and above.

Indrajaal, Sigma Advanced Systems partner to manufacture drones

Counter-unmanned aircraft solutions firm, Indrajaal, has partnered with Sigma Advanced Systems to strengthen the indigenous manufacturing of anti-drone defence systems in India. Sigma will domestically produce essential hardware components for Indrajaal's drone countermeasure systems. Kiran Raju, Co-Founder of Indrajaal, expressed his enthusiasm about the partnership, emphasizing the alignment of Sigma's SAS manufacturing expertise with their commitment to delivering quality, indigenous counter-drone solutions.

Microsoft, AICTE partner to equip students with tech skills

The Ministry of Education, All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE), and Microsoft have partnered to provide skilling and job readiness for students and educators. The partnership offers many learning paths, technical certifications, and experiences in AI, cloud, data science, data analytics, and security.

SNIPPETS



- Micron Technology to invest \$75M for semiconductor project in Idaho
- LG Energy signs deal with Toyota for 20GWh of EV batteries
- NIC, Cadence partner to bolster IC design innovation in Vietnam
- Reliance enters battery swap game, unveils swappable multipurpose batteries
- Pegatron India resumes iPhone production after fire incident in Chennai unit
- Tesla rival VinFast eyes billion dollar investment in Indian EV industry
- Ather Energy's losses swell 2.5 times to reach 8.65 billion rupees in FY23
- Sun Mobility, Bluwheelz to deploy 16,000 EVs in 12 months
- Rajasthan's new renewable energy policy targets 65GW solar capacity by FY30

Microsoft will integrate Microsoft Learn into AICTE's curriculum, providing practical exposure to Microsoft technologies. Students and educators will gain industry insights and mentorship through the Azure developer community in India. Azure Handbooks will provide access for students and educators to work on projects in various industries, including manufacturing, retail, healthcare, and education.

TATA Power Renewable Energy partners with Nepal's Dugar Power

Tata Power Renewable Energy (TPREL) has collaborated with Dugar Power in Nepal to support the nation's renewable energy projects, marking the former's entry into Nepal's growing renewable energy sector. The agreement caters to Nepal's diverse energy requirements, offering scalable solutions from 1kW to MW levels. TPREL aims to accelerate the country's transition to sustainable energy. Dugar Power is a subsidiary of the Dugar Group in Nepal.

Beetel Teletech partners with Numeric UPS to distribute UPS systems

Beetel Teletech Limited has partnered with Numeric UPS to address the critical need for uninterrupted power supply in India and globally, aiming to provide cutting-edge power solutions to businesses and consumers. Beetel will utilise its extensive distribution network and market presence to bring Numeric UPS's diverse product portfolio directly to corporate and government entities.